

Drummer James Stretton

British Army Service Record Evidence Package

Regiment	73rd Regiment of Foot
Archive	The National Archives, London
Digital provider	Findmypast
Collection	WO97: Chelsea Pensioners British Army Service Records 1760-1913
TNA UK reference	WO 97/856/67, Page 2
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Package	Synopsis, key facts, chronology, research notes and nine original record images

Source citation

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Synopsis

James Stretton was born in Birmingham, Warwickshire, and worked as a labourer before joining the 73rd Regiment of Foot at Nottingham on 11 August 1809, aged 15. His earliest service was therefore under age and was not counted in the same way as adult pensionable service.

The service statements record him as a drummer and private. His reckonable adult service included 16 years and 146 days to the end of 1828, followed by 5 years and 219 days to 7 August 1834. The record then explicitly adds **two years for Waterloo**, producing 24 years of reckonable service. A further 33 days to his final discharge gave a recorded total of **24 years and 33 days**.

He served overseas in Germany, Flanders and France for a combined two years and six months; the remainder of his service was at home. The papers do not allocate precise dates to each overseas posting, although the Waterloo allowance and continental-service entry establish his participation in the Waterloo campaign.

Stretton was discharged because of constitutional ulceration of the right leg and thigh. A medical certificate states that he had suffered from the condition for approximately four years and was thereby unfit for further service. His conduct was considered good, except that he was described as rather addicted to drink, for which he had been punished.

At discharge he was recorded as 40 years old, 5 feet 5 inches tall, with fair hair, grey eyes and a fair complexion. His trade was again given as labourer.

Key facts

Fact	Reading
Birth and trade	Birmingham, Warwickshire; labourer
Attestation	Nottingham, 11 August 1809; age 15
Waterloo	Two additional reckonable years
Total service	24 years 33 days reckonable
Overseas	Germany, Flanders and France; 2 years 6 months
Discharge cause	Constitutional ulceration of right leg and thigh
Character	Good, except rather addicted to drink
Description	Age 40; 5 ft 5 in; fair hair; grey eyes; fair complexion

Waterloo interpretation

The two years are an additional pensionable or reckonable-service credit, not two extra calendar years actually served. The form separately records actual adult service, the Waterloo allowance and the resulting total used for discharge or pension purposes.

Service chronology

Date or period	Event	Page
11 Aug 1809	Attested at Nottingham, aged 15	1, 3
Early service	Drummer; marked under age	1, 4
8 Aug 1812 - 31 Dec 1828	Adult service: 16 years 146 days	1, 4
Waterloo	Two years added to reckonable service	1, 4
1 Jan 1829 - 7 Aug 1834	Further service: 5 years 219 days	1, 4
7 Aug 1834	Regimental board at Dover Castle	2, 3
8 Aug - 9 Sep 1834	Further 33 days to final discharge	1

Further research

- Search the Waterloo Medal Roll and 73rd Regiment muster rolls to confirm his company and status during the campaign.
- Use muster books and pay lists to establish exact postings, rank changes and periods abroad.
- Search Chelsea pension records for the pension rate and subsequent residence.

Document inventory

Image	Description
1	Statement of service and reckonable service
2	Overseas service, disability, character and pay
3	Regimental board proceedings
4	Detailed service table
5	Disability, conduct and pay details
6	Board certification and signatures
7	Medical certificate and discharge description
8	Discharge document copy
9	Soldier declaration and attestation notes

Statement of service and reckonable service

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D. B. 10/8/34 *U*

HIS MAJESTY'S

REGT. *B^d* OF *Foot*

Whereof *Sir John Sir Paul Adam KCB* is Colonel.

No. *23* *Drummer James Sutton*

BORN in the Parish of *Birmingham* in or near the Town of *Birmingham* in the County of *Warwick* by Trade a *Sabrier*

ATTESTED for the *B^d* Regiment of *Foot* at *Nottingham* in the County of *Nottingham* on the *11 August 1809* at the Age of *Seventeen*

1st. SERVICE. AFTER the Age of 18 Years, which he is entitled to reckon up to the *1 August 1834* is *Twenty Four* years the statement of which is as follows.

Regiment.	Promotions, Reductions, &c.	Rank.	Period of Service in each Rank.		Amount of Service.	
			From	To	Years.	Days.
<i>B^d Foot</i>		<i>Drummer</i>	<i>8 Aug 1809</i>	<i>7 Aug 1812</i>	<i>Under age</i>	
"		<i>Drum</i>	<i>8 Aug 1812</i>	<i>31 Dec 1818</i>	<i>16</i>	<i>146</i>
"		<i>Drum</i>	<i>1 Jan 1829</i>	<i>7 Aug 1834</i>	<i>5</i>	<i>219</i>

For Soldiers enlisted previous to the 15th March, 1818.

	From	To	Years.	Days.		
* <i>INDIA</i> { <i>East</i>	<i>/</i>	<i>/</i>	<i>/</i>	<i>/</i>	<i>Half</i>	
<i>West</i>	<i>/</i>	<i>/</i>	<i>/</i>	<i>/</i>	<i>Half</i>	
* WATERLOO						
Total of the foregoing Statement					<i>24</i>	<i>33</i>
Deduct						
Total Service up to the <i>7 August 1834</i>					<i>24</i>	<i>33</i>
A Non-commissioned Officer, enlisted after the 14th November, 1829, must have served not less than Three Years without interruption as such, immediately preceding his discharge. Vide Art. 6 of the Pensioner Regulations.						
Of which, as <i>Corporal</i> <i>Sergeant</i> <i>Sergeant-major</i>						
* Further Service from the <i>8 Aug 1834</i> to the <i>7 Sept 1834</i> when finally discharged . .					<i>"</i>	<i>33</i>
Total Service allowed to reckon to the day of final discharge.					<i>24</i>	<i>33</i>

* To be erased, when not required, by drawing the Pen through the Lines.

SERVED.	In Germany, Flanders and France Two years and six Months and the remainder at Home. —
2nd. DISABILITY. or Cause of Discharge.	Ulcerations of the Right leg and thigh of a Constitutional character —
3rd. CHARACTER.	The Regimental Board is of opinion, that his character has been good with the exception of being rather addicted to drink which he has of late forsaken. —
4th PAY and CLOTHING.	He has received all just Demands from his Entry into the Service, up to the 1st August 1834 Inclusive with the exception of Compensation for a Regt Black Cap from the 1st April 1834 up to 1st Aug 1834, also for and Provision for the same period. — L. P. Smith
Certified <u>Wm. B. Bower</u> Regt Captain	
I CERTIFY that the foregoing Statements are correct Extracts from the Regimental Records, and the Proceedings of the Regimental Board.	
<u>Wm. B. Bower</u> Captain Major , and President.	
Confirmed by me, <u>A. Hamilton</u> Major Lieutenant Colonel Commanding.	
Dover Castle 7 May 1834	

Proceedings of a Regimental Board,
held in conformity to the Articles of War, for the purpose of
verifying and recording the Services, Conduct, Character, and cause
of Discharge of *No 23 Drummer James Stetton*
Seventy Third Regiment of Foot.

Dover Castle 7 August 1884

President { *Captain J. B. Bower*
Members { *A. W. Bantford*
 { *H. B. Harvey*

Drummer James Stetton appeared, and the Board having
personally examined and compared the Regimental
Records, the Soldier's Book, and other documents,
report to the following effect,

Born, { *in the Parish of Birmingham in or near the Town*
 { *of Birmingham in the County of Warwick*
 { *by Trade a Labourer.*

Attested, { *for the Seventy Third Regiment of Foot at Nottingham*
 { *in the County of Nottingham on the 11 Aug*
 { *1884 at the Age of Fifteen*

Service, { *which he is entitled to reckon, after making every*
 { *deduction required by His Majesty's Regulations*
 { *up to the 7 August 1884 is Twenty Four*
 { *Years* the
 { *details of which, as extracted from the Regimental*
 { *documents, are stated on the following page.....*

Regiment.	Promotions Reductions &c.	Rank.	Period of Service in each Rank.		Amount of Service	
			From	To	Years	Days.
<i>3rd Foot</i>		<i>Drummer</i>	<i>8 Aug 1809</i>	<i>7 Aug 1812</i>	<i>Under age</i>	
<i>"</i>		<i>ditto</i>	<i>8 Aug 1812</i>	<i>31 Dec 1818</i>	<i>16</i>	<i>14. 6</i>
<i>"</i>	<i>Waterloo</i>				<i>2</i>	<i>"</i>
<i>"</i>		<i>Drummer</i>	<i>1 Jan 1829</i>	<i>7 Aug 1834</i>	<i>5</i>	<i>219</i>
<i>Total</i>					<i>24</i>	<i>"</i>

Served in Germany, Holland and France two years and six months and the remainder at Home. —

Disability or Cause of Discharge reported annexed, that this is a case of Ulcerations of the Right leg and thigh of a Constitutional Character, and the Board concur in the opinion of the Assistant Surgeon.

Conduct

and

Character.

The Officers composing the Board having examined the Defaulter's Book, and received parole testimony from Captain Bampton are of opinion that his conduct has been good with the exception of being rather addicted to drink which he has of late forsaken.

Pay and
Clothing

Dr. Jas. Shelton being asked up to what period he has been paid, answered that his Account was balanced up to the 23 of the present Month, being further asked whether he has any other claim on the Regiment for arrears of Pay, Allowances, or Clothing, answered, that, he claims compensation for a Regimental Black Cap from the 1st April 1834 up to the 7th Aug 1834 also for a Coat and Trowsers for the same period.

The Board have verified that his Soldiers Book is correctly balanced, and signed by the Officer Commanding his Company, and they further declare, that they have impartially enquired into and faithfully reported their Opinion on all the matters brought before them, in accordance with the Regulations and Instructions issued by His Majestys Orders

Thos B. Kiser. Capt. & President.
W. B. M. P. a Captain
 A. W. H. a Captain

Note. It is desired that this size and form of report may be invariably adhered to.

By Authority

London. Printed & Sold by W. Clowes 14 Charing Cross.

Dover August 7th 1834

I hereby certify that Drummer James Stutton
has been for the last 4 years affected with
ulcerations of the right leg and thigh of a
constitutional character and it is my opinion
that he is thereby unfitted for further service

19 August 1834
The Surgeon, 1st Regt
and treated
by the Surgeon

Maxwell Towell
M^d Surgeon 1st Regt

D. B. B. M^d
D. M. M^d

Horse Guards, 9th Sept 1834

Confirmed
J. G. G. M^d
D. M. M^d

DECISION. The Commissioners award _____ to receive a Pension of _____
a day, commencing _____
Secretary, or Chief Clerk.

DESCRIPTION Of James Stutton at the time of his Discharge.
He is 40 Years of Age, 5 Feet 5 Inches in Height, Fair Hair,
grey Eyes, fair Complexion.
By Trade a Labourer

When he left the Regiment, J. M. M^d was the Pay-Serjeant of
his Company.

MARCHING ALLOWANCE. _____ received from _____ at _____
on the _____ Days' Marching Allowance,
to carry him to _____ the place of his enlistment, or to
the Port at which he is to embark on the way to the place of his
enlistment.

OPINION.	Of the Principal Medical Officer, at <i>Chatham</i> <i>19 August 1834</i>
<i>James Stretton is unfit for Service, the old ulceration is at present healed and treatment in Hospital is not likely to be of any advantage to him in <i>England</i></i> <i>P. H. C.</i>	
Horse Guards, <i>9th Sept 1834</i>	
<i>Confirmed</i> <i>W. H. C.</i>	
DECISION.	The Commissioners award _____ to receive a Pension of _____ a day, commencing _____ Secretary, or Chief Clerk.
DESCRIPTION	Of <i>James Stretton</i> at the time of his Discharge. He is <i>40</i> Years of Age, <i>5</i> Feet <i>5</i> Inches in Height, <i>Fair</i> Hair, <i>grey</i> Eyes, <i>fair</i> Complexion. By Trade a <i>Labourer</i>
When he left the Regiment, <i>J. Mathison</i> was the Pay-Serjeant of his Company.	
MARCHING ALLOWANCE.	received from _____ at _____ on the _____ Days' Marching Allowance, to carry him to _____ the place of his enlistment, or to the Port at which he is to embark on the way to the place of his enlistment.

I, _____ in the _____ of _____ hereby declare that I do, of my own free will, request to be discharged from His Majesty's Service; and I further declare, that a period of not less than Thirty Days has elapsed since I first made application for my Discharge; and it has been fully explained to me, and I perfectly understand, that in receiving my Discharge at my own request, I entirely relinquish all Claim to Pension, and that, even if I should re-enlist, my past Services prior to the Date of my present Discharge cannot be allowed to be reckoned for the purpose of obtaining any benefit from Chelsea Hospital.

Witnessed and certified by me,

Officer Commanding the Company.

BY AUTHORITY.

London: Printed and Sold by W. CLOWES, 14, Charing Cross